

APR 2026

HOW WE RUN ROADMAPS AT FLOCK

PRODTECH – INTRODUCING NOW / NEXT / LATER



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AGENDA

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- 3 INITIATIVES VS PROJECTS
- 4 WHERE THE ROADMAP LIVES
- 5 SQUAD WALKTHROUGHS – LIVE IN LINEAR

PRIORITISATION IS
PLACING **BETS**, NOT
PLANNING **DELIVERABLES**.

NOW / NEXT / LATER ROADMAPPING

Describes Outcomes and our appetite + readiness to work on them, not delivery dates and sequencing.

NOW

Resourced or in progress - aligned internally on this being the biggest impact thing we could be working on.

NEXT

There's a clear need and clarity around how we'd measure success. We have an idea of solutions we'd build to achieve the outcomes.

LATER

Candidates for prioritisation. We know why it matters, not yet how we'd capitalise on the opportunity.

STAGES REPRESENT COMMITMENT, NOT TIME.

IT WORKS AT ANY GRANULARITY

The same Now/Next/Later framing can be applied at very different horizons. The stages describe maturity, not duration.

INITIATIVES

2-YEAR HORIZON

Company-wide bets, 3–6 months of work each.
Reviewed quarterly by SLT, tied to OKRs.

e.g. NEW HAULAGE PRODUCT LAUNCH

PROJECTS

3–6 MONTH HORIZON

ProdTech-owned and executed, 2–12 weeks each.
Reviewed monthly by ProdTech Leads.

e.g. CRASH DETECTION ENoL ROLLOUT

OUR FLAVOUR — DEFINITION OF READY

Lightweight gating to move a Project through each stage. Enough to have the right conversation, no more.

NOW

RESOURCED OR IN PROGRESS

Resourcing booked in so we can crack on and ship.

NEXT

READY TO GO

A measurable outcome tied to a strategic goal (or a clear path to one). Good understanding of what to build, plus a t-shirt size off the back of light scoping into how.

LATER

CANDIDATE FOR PRIORITISATION

A descriptive title and enough articulation of why we'd do this to have the conversation. Expected to sit here for months as context shifts.

WHO OWNS WHAT

Clear accountability across the lifecycle — but everyone's ideas and opinions are welcome.

WHY

OUTCOMES

OWNED BY PRODUCT

The customer or business outcome we're chasing — and why it's worth chasing now.

WHAT

OPPORTUNITIES

OWNED BY PRODUCT
SIZED BY ENGINEERING

The opportunity or problem space we're attacking, and the shape of what we'll build.

HOW

SOLUTIONS & DELIVERY

OWNED BY ENGINEERING

The technical approach, the trade-offs, and shipping quality product.

ONE ROADMAP.
ONE SOURCE
OF TRUTH.

WHY WE'RE TYING THE ROADMAP TO LINEAR

THE PROBLEM

Roadmaps have been so far been snapshots created ad-hoc rather than an integral part of our process. We're also increasingly finding the need for easily discoverable context for any given project for both human and agent use. This might currently sit across Notion docs, Slack threads, and Granola notes, often poorly linked. Outcomes get disconnected from delivery, and the next person to pick something up has to reconstruct it.

RECONSTRUCTING CONTEXT IS EXPENSIVE.

THE BET

Having a consolidated place for tracking upcoming work will reduce ad-hoc / poorly structured context.

Linear doesn't need to absorb every detail. It signposts out - to the strategy doc, the research, the design file, the data - so the trail from outcome to delivery is always one click away.

LINEAR SIGNPOSTS WHERE NECESSARY CONTEXT LIVES.

TWO LEVELS — BOTH IN LINEAR

Both Initiatives and Projects live in Linear. They may link out to Notion views or other docs, but Linear is the source of truth.

INITIATIVES

3–6 MONTH, COMPANY-WIDE

- Reviewed quarterly by SLT
- Tied closely to the OKR process
- Some have little/no ProdTech involvement
- Tracked in Linear (links out to Notion)

PROJECTS

2–12 WEEK, PRODTech-OWNED

- Reviewed monthly by ProdTech Leads
- Owned and executed by squads
- Should serve a Now Initiative
- Tracked in Linear

NO FORCED 1:1 MAPPING — SOME INITIATIVES HAVE NO PROJECTS, AND VICE VERSA.

INITIATIVE ROADMAP

Initiatives plotted Now/Next/Later across the next two years. Projects sit beneath, plotted over a rolling 3–6 month horizon, always in aid of a Now initiative (though they may benefit others too).

NOW

REST OF 2026

Initiatives we're committed to and actively resourcing.

NEXT

2027

Initiatives we expect to take on next, with enough shape to discuss.

LATER

2028+

Bigger bets we want to keep in view as the strategy evolves.

PROJECTS

Plotted Now/Next/Later on a rolling 3–6 month horizon — always serving a Now initiative.

OVER TO
THE SQUADS.